

2 Business content

1 – Business activity and influences on business

This section covers the various objectives of a business, changing business environments and the criteria for judging success. The focus is on the importance of having clear business objectives and how the business environment provides opportunities for, and imposes constraints on, the pursuit of these objectives.

2 – People in business

This section looks at people in organisations, focusing on their roles, relationships and management in business.

3 – Business finance

This section explores the use of accounting and financial information as an aid to decision making.

4 – Marketing

This section focuses on identifying and satisfying customer needs in a changing and competitive international environment.

5 – Business operations

This section examines the way organisations use and manage resources to produce goods and services.

Paper 1 and Paper 2

Externally assessed

Content description

Learners need to demonstrate specified knowledge and critical understanding of the following sections:

1. Business activity and influences on business
2. People in business
3. Business finance
4. Marketing
5. Business operations.

Section 1: introduces the nature and types of business in an economy. Learners will be encouraged to examine the interaction between businesses and the environment in which they operate.

Sections 2–5: focuses on the main functional areas of business administration, finance, marketing and operations.

While the five sections of content are listed as discrete topics, it is important for learners to recognise that, because business is dynamic, these five areas interrelate.

How content relates to examination papers

The examination for Paper 1 and Paper 2 can draw on the knowledge and understanding from across the entire specification content. The five sections of business content interrelate and can be applied to real-life business scenarios that cover both small and large businesses.

Paper 1 will focus on a small business of up to 49 employees that has a local/national market.

Paper 2 will focus on a large business of more than 250 employees that has a multinational/global market.
